

CRIME INVESTIGATION - VICTIM AND INCIDENT REPORT

Case Reference: NGP-2026-FR-0058

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Date: Complaint: 20 June 2026 | Report: 22 June 2026

1. Victim Overview

Victim: Vidarbha Urban Cooperative Bank, Nagpur, with roughly 24,000 depositors, mostly small traders, pensioners and salaried families. A Reserve Bank inspection in June 2026 found that Rs. 14.2 crore had been sanctioned as loans to 63 borrowers who could not be traced or who had never applied for loans.

2. Incident Summary

Over about three years, loans were sanctioned against forged identity documents, inflated property valuations and manipulated records. Repayments on the earliest loans were made using funds from newer loans, hiding the fraud. The scheme collapsed when the bank could no longer roll over the fake accounts. The chairman has been unreachable since 15 June.

3. Detection

A director, Dr. Shirish Pande, had recorded written objections to several loan approvals over two years and resigned in March. A peon, Ramesh Gaikwad, passed a bundle of loan files to RBI inspectors after noticing the same photograph on different applications.

4. Loss to Depositors

Withdrawals have been frozen by the regulator. About Rs. 9 crore of the sanctioned amount has been traced to accounts controlled by a small group. Depositors have protested outside the bank.